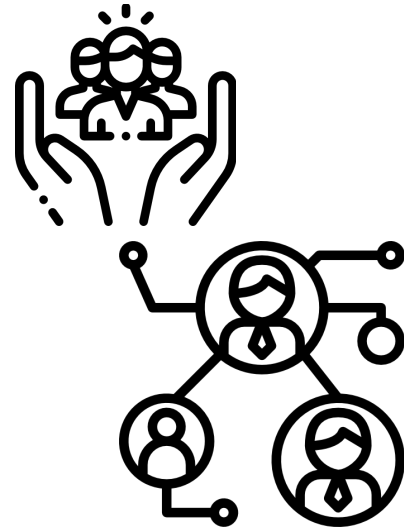
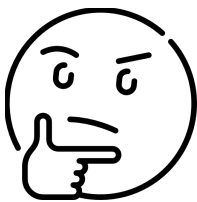


BUILDING COLLABORATIVE COMMUNITY

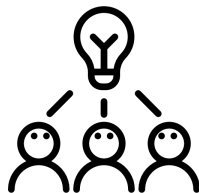


Succeeding in your goals is not only about the work you put in, it's about your network of support. Often, we think of our networks as only being those who work in our profession, but in reality, the network that supports us may be composed of not only colleagues, but friends, and family.

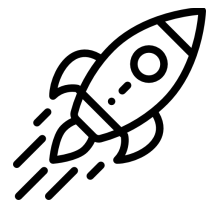
In this activity, we use “collaborative community” here to mean the broad framework of people who can help support you in your efforts.



1. THINK



2. IDENTIFY



3. ACT

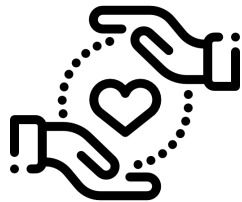


PART 1: THINK

UNDERSTANDING YOUR NEEDS

In the first part of this activity, we'll reflect on what you need, and who you have in your community already.

There are four primary types of social support that help people navigate stress, risk, and growth:



EMOTIONAL

Emotional support is about concern, trust, affection, or approval. This nurturing support is your shoulder to lean on—where you get warmth and assurance.



INFORMATIONAL

Informational support is about advice, knowledge, or guidance. These supporters help you solve problems, navigate decisions, or think critically.



TANGIBLE

Tangible support is about giving time, resources, or services. These supporters roll up their sleeve to help tackle tasks, manage challenges, brainstorm solutions, or actualize concrete plans.



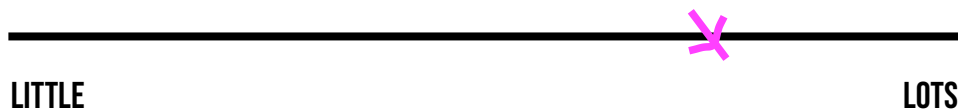
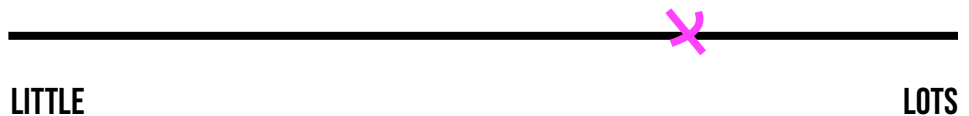
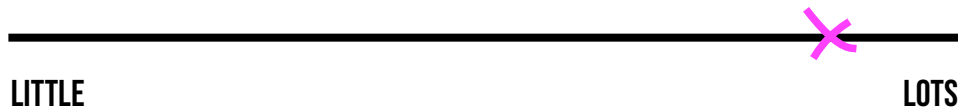
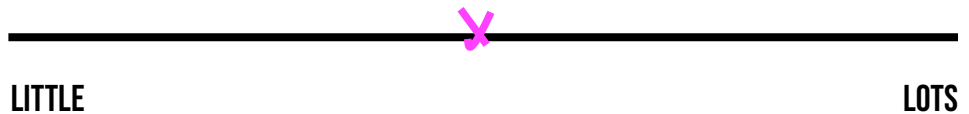
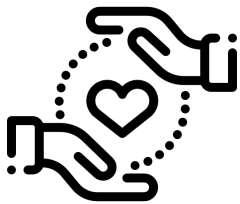
COMPANIONSHIP

Companionship support is about a sense of belonging and shared experience. These supporters have been in your shoes and make you feel at home.

PART 1: THINK

SEE WHERE YOU'RE AT / SEE WHERE YOU WANT TO BUILD

Here, we figure out which dimensions of support you might want to work on most. Below, mark the line with an X to reflect the level of support you feel you currently have in each of the four dimensions.

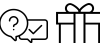




PART 2: IDENTIFY

NAME YOUR NETWORK

Many people in our network play roles along multiple dimensions. In the boxes below, note 1-3 names for any of the example roles, and/or make up new roles using the blank boxes on the next page.

THE CHEERLEADER  Who provides encouragement when you need it most? Elizabeth	THE COMRADE  Who is your partner in crime? Lauren	THE FIXER  Who do you turn to when you want to troubleshoot? Andrew
THE CONNECTOR  Who is your social or professional matchmaker? Nitya	THE HELPING HAND  Who can you count on to pitch in when you're in a pinch? Daphne	THE EXPERT  Who do you turn to for inside knowledge? Alex J
THE EXAMPLE  Who do you look up to that always seems to have it figured out? Ani	THE MENTOR  Who do you turn to for counsel and thoughtful guidance? Danya	THE INSTIGATOR  Who motivates you to jump in and start something? Advisors/ grads

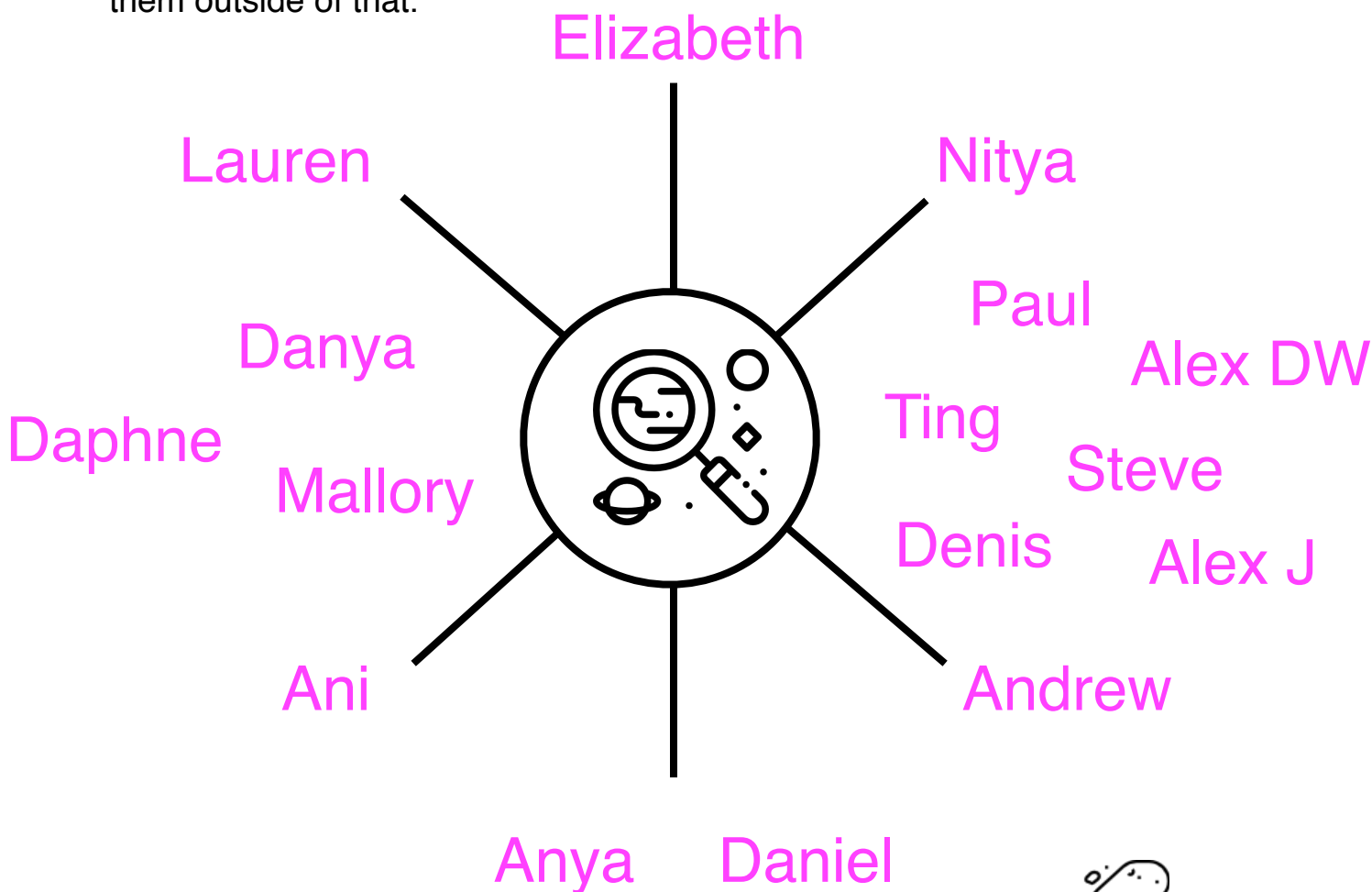
NOTES:



PART 2: IDENTIFY

BUILDING THE BRAIN TRUST

Go back to your brainstorm on the dimensions of support in Part 1, and compare with the roles and people you just wrote down. What kind of support do you most need right now, and who might be able to provide it for you? Write in 4-6 people on the spokes below who you'd like to be your "inner circle". If there are other people you'd like to keep in your orbit, write them outside of that.



PART 3: ACT

REACHING OUT

A community is built from mutual bonds— if bonds are strong, the community supports not only you, but everyone you share it with. However, building connections can be challenging, in a variety of ways! If you want to make a new connection, you must figure out how to be in touch with that person; on the other hand, if you are already connected, you must help the connection grow.

On the previous page, you identified your “brain trust”, the inner circle of people who you most need support from right now. Now, let’s build a plan.

How will you reach out and connect? Jot down some ideas below.

Start planning future people to work

Email about projects

Ask new advisors/mentors to meet
semi-regularly

Are there any **challenges** you face in reaching out? What are they?

Not enough time

Already have big collaborations

PART 3: ACT

MAKE YOUR PLAN

Below, spell out what **near-term actions** you want to take to help build and/or strengthen your community connections:

WHO	HOW	WHEN
Denis	Plan next meeting	2 weeks

Notes: